

Imagine that each of the three style sheets features a rule called `#header`. The declaration for `#header` in each style sheet features the same properties (say height, width, and color), although the value of each is different. In this instance, the browser will consider the last linked style sheet (`three.css`) as most important and perform any rules it contains. Any rules not defined in `three.css` will be performed from the second style sheet (`two.css`). Finally, the browser will perform any remaining styles from `one.css`. Always remember that the later a rule is specified, the more weight it is given.

The hierarchy and cascade is also present within the imported style sheets. As with the previous examples, it's all about the order in which the style sheets are specified. We have seen modular CSS, where the CSS for a site is organized into relevant style sheets. Here's a similar example where four modules imported via a master external style sheet called `external.css`. `external.css` contains the following lines:

```
@import url("default.css");  
@import url("layout.css");  
@import url("navigation.css");  
@import url("forms.css");
```

`forms.css` is highest in the hierarchy, whereas `default.css` is the lowest. Let's assume that in `navigation.css` (second in the hierarchy) there is a class called `highlight`, used to render text red. Let's also assume that `highlight` appears in `default.css`, but is used to render text orange. As `navigation.css` has more weight due to its place in the hierarchy, the rendered text will be red. Yet still, `forms.css` isn't necessarily top of the tree. Remember that these style sheets are being imported via a master external style sheet.

Always at the bottom of the cascade hierarchy, the browser's default style sheet will have default settings for headings, paragraphs, lists, and all common HTML elements. It is the browser style sheet that makes links blue and visited links purple unless something different is specified in the sites style sheets. View a page in the browser that isn't styled using CSS, and you will see the default browser styles. As long as you define all the elements you wish to control, their defaults from the browser CSS will be overridden.

## 2.3 Grouping

Another very important principle for writing well organised CSS is grouping. To illustrate grouping, let's consider the following example,